

Class IX — *India and the Contemporary World – I*

What this book actually is: the first NCERT that is **not** about India. Three of its five chapters are **World History** — the French Revolution, the Russian Revolution, Nazism — and the other two are **social and environmental history** of colonialism. For UPSC this book is worth far more than its school-level packaging suggests, because **GS Paper I Mains has an explicit World History component** and this is where the ideas in it are first laid out.

Where this book sits in the UPSC syllabus

The Mains GS Paper I syllabus says, word for word:

"History of the world will include events from 18th century such as industrial revolution, world wars, redrawal of national boundaries, colonization, decolonization, political philosophies like communism, capitalism, socialism etc. — their forms and effect on the society."

Read that list again and map it onto this book:

UPSC SYLLABUS PHRASE	->	CHAPTER THAT STARTS IT
"events from 18th century"	->	Ch.1 French Revolution (1789)
"political philosophies like communism ... socialism"	->	Ch.2 Socialism & Russian Revolution
"world wars"	->	Ch.3 Nazism (WWI aftermath -> WWII)
"redrawal of national boundaries"	->	Ch.3 Versailles, 1919
"colonization ... effect on the society"	->	Ch.4 Forest Society and Colonialism Ch.5 Pastoralists in the Modern World

Every phrase of the World History syllabus has its seed in this one book. Nothing else in the NCERT series covers the French and Russian Revolutions at all until Class 11's *Themes in World History*.

The five chapters

#	Chapter	Period	Prelims	Mains	Status
1	The French Revolution	1774–1804	★★	★★★★★	✓
2	Socialism in Europe and the Russian Revolution	1850s–1940s	★★	★★★★★	✓
3	Nazism and the Rise of Hitler	1918–1945	★★	★★★★★	✓
4	Forest Society and Colonialism	1700s–1940s	★★★	★★★★	✓
5	Pastoralists in the Modern World	1800s–1900s	★★★	★★★★	✓
6	SUPPLEMENT — Peasants and Farmers · Clothing: A Social History	1650s–1947	★★★	★★★★★	✓

Section I — Events and Processes (Ch.1–3): three revolutions in the meaning of *who the state belongs to*.

Section II — Livelihoods, Economies and Societies (Ch.4–5): what colonial rule did to people who lived off forests and off the move.

⚠ Chapters NCERT removed — and what we are doing about them

The current edition pushes **three chapters** out of the printed book into "extended learning" behind a QR code:

Removed chapter	UPSC value	Our decision
Peasants and Farmers	★★★ Enclosures, the agricultural revolution in England, the US wheat frontier, opium and China — feeds GS1 world history <i>and</i> the Indian agrarian story	✅ Restored — 06_Supplement Part A
Clothing: A Social History	★★ Sumptuary laws, the swadeshi/khadi argument, caste conflict over dress	✅ Restored — 06_Supplement Part B
History and Sport: Cricket	★ Colonial sport and social hierarchy; occasionally an essay hook	Noted, not expanded — PDF available if wanted

📄 **Source:** the removed chapters are **not on ncert.nic.in and not in the archive.org copy of the current edition**. They were recovered from a **scan of the pre-rationalisation 8-chapter edition**, now stored at [../Textbook_PDF/Removed_Chapters_Old_Edition/](#) — its README records how it was found and the OCR errors to watch for.

This is the same call we made for **Class 7**, where NCERT deleted *Rulers and Buildings* and *Towns, Traders and Craftpersons* and we wrote them back in as a supplement. **NCERT's rationalisation is a school-workload decision, not a UPSC-relevance decision**. Do not confuse the two.

🕒 How to read these five chapters

Chapters 1–3 form one continuous argument, and you lose most of the value if you read them separately.

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1789  FRENCH REVOLUTION
      "The nation belongs to the PEOPLE, not the king."
      Invents: citizen, nation, rights, liberty, equality
              |
              | But equality of WHAT?
              | Political rights only, or bread too?
              v
1848+ SOCIALISM
      "Political equality is empty while property is private."
      Marx: capitalists profit from workers' labour
              |
              | Can this be won by voting, or only by revolution?
              v
1917  RUSSIAN REVOLUTION
      The first state to answer: revolution, then abolish
      private property. Land to the tillers, factories to workers.
              |
              | Backlash. Plus a lost war and a broken economy.
              v
1933  NAZISM
      The counter-revolution: rejects liberty, equality AND
      socialism. Nation defined by BLOOD, not by consent.
      Ends in war and genocide.
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Read across that arrow and you can answer almost any GS1 question on modern political philosophies. Read the chapters as four separate story-books and you will have four sets of dates and no argument.

Chapters 4–5 are a different kind of history entirely — no great men, no dates you must memorise, but the most **directly examinable** content in the book. Forest Rights, shifting cultivation, pastoral commons and

grazing bans come up in **Prelims (Environment)**, **GS1 (society)** and **GS3 (environment, agriculture)** every single year.

Where this book connects to what you already know

From this book	Links back to
Ch.4 forest laws, <i>jhum</i> , reserved forests	Class 8 Ch.4 — the same policy, seen from the tribal side (Birsa Munda)
Ch.4 forest villages, cheap labour	Class 8 Ch.4 — the Forest Department's labour supply
Ch.5 Criminal Tribes Act 1871, grazing tax	Class 8 Ch.4 — the colonial state's suspicion of mobile people
Ch.1 "the nation belongs to the people"	Class 8 Ch.8 — what the Indian national movement was claiming
Ch.2 socialism reaching India	Class 8 Ch.8 — the 1917 Russian Revolution's effect on Indian nationalists
Ch.3 Versailles, self-determination	Class 10 Ch.1–2 — nationalism in Europe and in India

The 12 things worth knowing cold from this book

1. **The three estates** and who paid the *taille* and the *tithe*.
2. **1789 → 1791 → 1792 → 1793 → 1804**: Estates-General, Constitution, Republic, Terror, Napoleon.
3. **The Declaration of the Rights of Man and Citizen** — and its **exclusions** (passive citizens, women, slaves).
4. **Olympe de Gouges** and the *Declaration of the Rights of Woman and the Female Citizen*.
5. **The abolition of slavery in 1794, its reintroduction by Napoleon, and final abolition in 1848.**
6. **Liberals / Radicals / Conservatives** — the three positions after 1815, and how they differ.
7. **Marx: capitalists, profit, and social ownership of the means of production.**
8. **February vs October 1917** — two different revolutions, months apart.
9. **Collectivisation, the kulaks, and the famine.**
10. **The Treaty of Versailles' terms and why they made Nazism possible.**
11. **Scientific forestry, the Forest Act, and *why* shifting cultivation was banned.**
12. **The Waste Land Rules, the Forest Acts and the Criminal Tribes Act — three laws with one logic: settle the mobile, tax the visible.**

Study order

If you are short of time and reading for UPSC rather than for school:

1. **Ch.4 and Ch.5 first** — highest Prelims yield, and they connect straight to Class 8 which you have just finished.
2. **Ch.1, then Ch.2, then Ch.3 in that order** — they only make sense in sequence.
3. **The supplement last.**